

## Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in Barcelona, Spain



La Delegación de Cataluña organiza la Campaña de Navidad 2016 a favor del Comedor Social "Reina de La Paz" de Barcelona - Orden Constantiniana - SACRA Y MILITAR ORDEN CONSTANTINIANA DE SAN JORGE  
<https://ordenconstantiniana.org/it/la-delegacion-de-cataluna-organiza-la-campana-de-navidad-2016-a-favor-del-comedor-social-reina-de-la-paz-de-barcelona>



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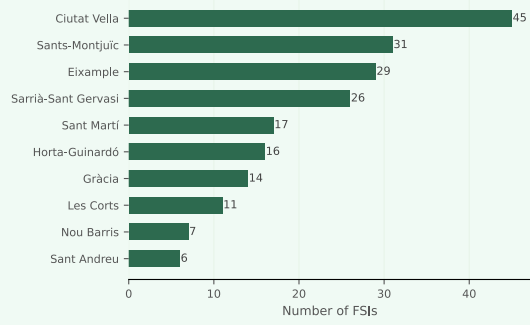


COMEDOR PARA LOS POBRES DE BARCELONA - COMUNIDAD DE SANT'EGIDIO  
<https://www.santegidio.org/pageID/30820/langID/es/COMEDOR-PARA-LOS-POBRES-DE-BARCELONA.html>

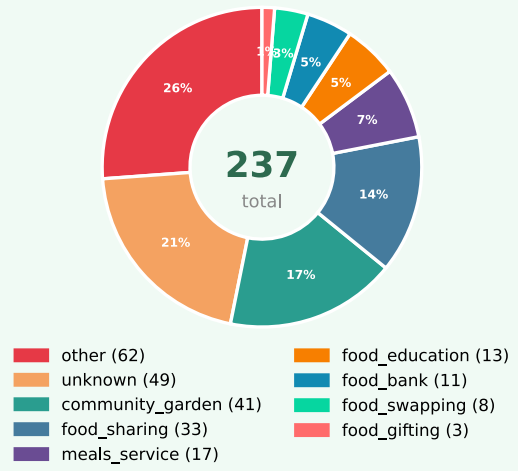


Contenedor solidario a favor de Banc d'Aliments de Barcelona  
<https://tma.es/contenedor-solidario>

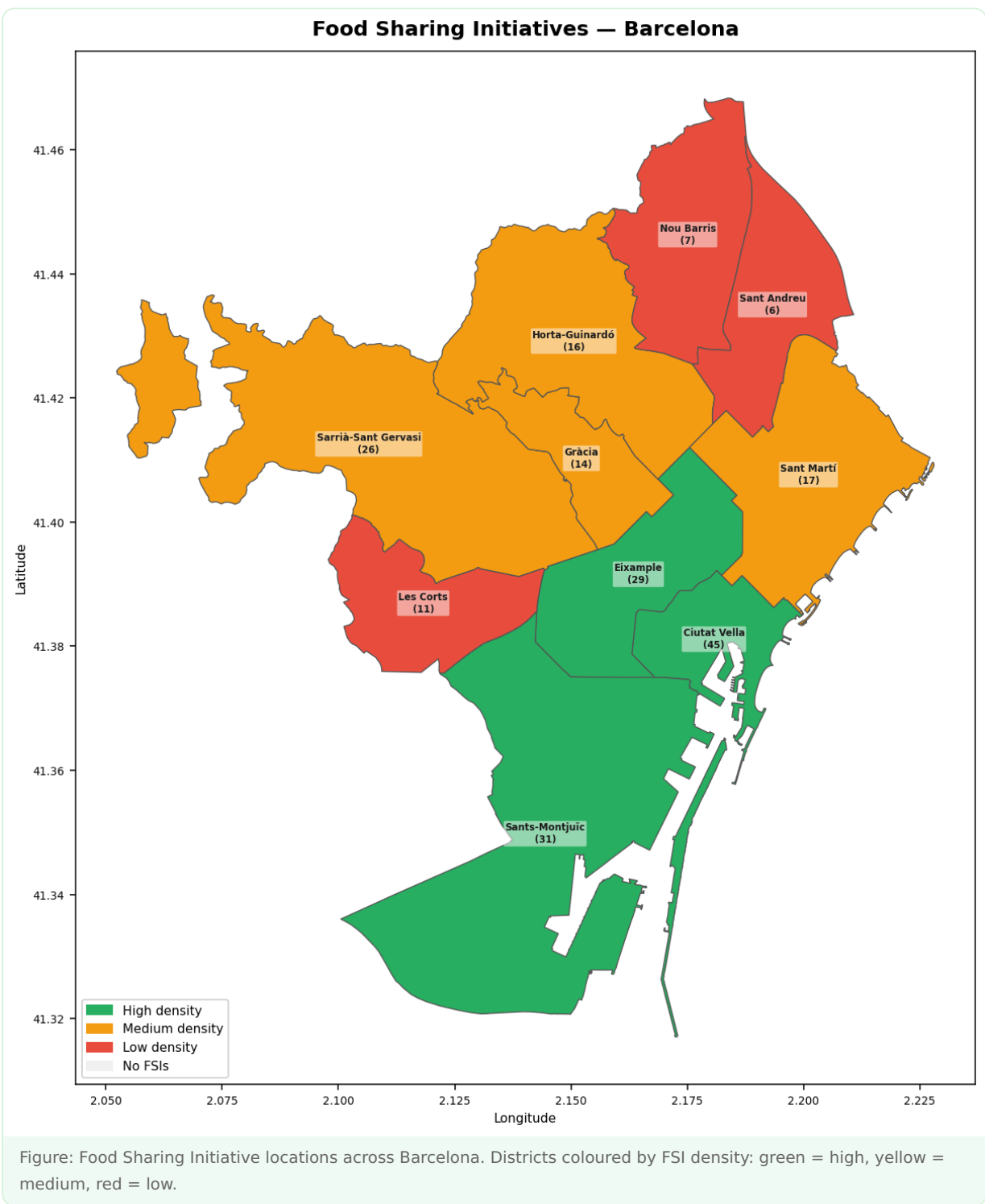
### FSIS BY DISTRICT



### FSI TYPE DISTRIBUTION



## Geographic Distribution



Barcelona hosts 237 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) across 10 postal districts, with the highest concentrations found in Ciutat Vella (45), Sants-Montjuïc (31), and Eixample (29), which together account for 44% of all FSIs in the city. These three districts, classified as "green" (high-density), collectively host 105 FSIs, reflecting a stark contrast with the "red" (low-density) districts of Les Corts (11), Nou Barris (7), and Sant Andreu (6), which together host only 24 FSIs. No district has fewer than six FSIs, with the lowest-count entries (Sant Andreu and Nou Barris) still maintaining multiple initiatives. The distribution

highlights a geographic imbalance, with central and historically vibrant districts dominating FSI activity compared to peripheral areas.

The "green" districts (Ciutat Vella, Sants-Montjuïc, Eixample) not only host the most FSIs but also exhibit a higher diversity of initiatives, including community gardens and cooperatives, as suggested by qualitative reports. In contrast, "yellow" (medium-density) districts like Sarrià-Sant Gervasi (26) and Gràcia (14) show intermediate activity, with Gràcia's 14 FSIs slightly below the green districts but still above the red group. The "red" districts, despite having fewer FSIs, maintain a minimum of six each, indicating that even lower-density areas have sustained food-sharing efforts. However, the absence of per capita data limits analysis of initiative density relative to population size, leaving questions about equity in resource distribution unanswered. The data also underscores that no district is isolated from FSIs, with even the least active areas hosting multiple initiatives.

## Types of Food Sharing Initiatives

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Barcelona hosts 237 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with the largest category being "other" initiatives (62, 26.2%), followed by "unknown" (49, 20.7%) and "community\_garden" (41, 17.3%). The most prominent focus area is sustainability, with 123 FSIs (51.9% of the total) explicitly emphasizing environmental goals, while 105 FSIs (44.3%) organize events or workshops, indicating a strong emphasis on community engagement. Food\_sharing initiatives (33, 13.9%) and meals\_service programs (17, 7.2%) represent smaller but distinct subgroups, reflecting diverse approaches to food redistribution and consumption. Notably, only 12 FSIs (5.5%) integrate educational components, suggesting a gap between outreach efforts and formal learning opportunities within the sector.

The disparity between sustainability-focused FSIs (123) and those with educational components (12) highlights uneven resource allocation across objectives, with the former outnumbering the latter by over tenfold. While 105 FSIs (44.3%) engage in events or workshops, this figure does not directly correlate with the 12 educational FSIs, implying that many event-based initiatives may lack structured pedagogical frameworks. The "other" category (62, 26.2%), though numerically dominant, remains the least defined in terms of specific activities, contrasting with the more clearly categorized "food\_bank" (11, 4.6%) and "food\_swapping" (8, 3.4%) initiatives. This ambiguity may reflect unclassified or hybrid models, complicating comparative analysis. Meanwhile, the relatively small number of food\_education FSIs (13, 5.5%) underscores a potential underinvestment in long-term capacity-building, despite the 105 event-organizing FSIs suggesting a preference for short-term engagement strategies.

## Operational and Funding Models

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Barcelona hosts 237 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with the majority (227, or 96%) being non-commercial, voluntary, or charity-based. Of these, 74 are community-led grassroots efforts, 46 are NGO-led, and 9 are government-funded, highlighting a strong reliance on local and non-profit models. Only 10 initiatives are commercial or social enterprises, while 3 are volunteer-based, underscoring the limited role of formal economic structures in this

sector. The data also reveals that 47 FSIs operate under a cooperative model, suggesting a significant emphasis on collective ownership and shared governance.

Community-led initiatives (74) outnumber NGO-led ones (46), reflecting a preference for grassroots autonomy over institutional oversight. However, NGO-led FSIs often engage in broader networks, with 1 initiative affiliated with known food networks, compared to 2 community groups that are informally run. The 9 government-funded FSIs, though fewer in number, are formally registered (8) or supported by councils (6), indicating a structured approach to oversight and resource allocation. Notably, only 3 FSIs are volunteer-based, a small fraction of the total, which contrasts with the 227 non-commercial initiatives that likely rely on a mix of unpaid labor and donations. This disparity highlights the varying degrees of institutional support and the challenges faced by initiatives that depend solely on community engagement.

## Reach and Activity

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Barcelona hosts 125 high-activity food sharing initiatives (FSIs), which outnumber the 112 low-activity FSIs by a significant margin, indicating a strong presence of active programs despite the absence of medium-activity FSIs. Collectively, these initiatives reference a total quantified volume of 2087 units of food (meals, kilograms, or members), reflecting substantial operational scale. Notably, 30 FSIs collaborate with farms, restaurants, or stores, suggesting a critical role for commercial partnerships in sustaining food redistribution efforts. This concentration of high-activity FSIs, combined with their integration into local supply chains, underscores a robust ecosystem for food sharing in the city.

Among target audiences, elderly individuals are prioritized by 36 FSIs, significantly more than the 23 FSIs targeting the general public, 8 focusing on low-income groups, and only 2 addressing students or children. This contrast highlights a pronounced emphasis on aging populations, potentially reflecting demographic needs or policy priorities in Barcelona. Meanwhile, the 30 FSIs collaborating with commercial entities may indicate a strategic focus on reducing food waste through partnerships, contrasting with initiatives targeting specific vulnerable groups. The absence of medium-activity FSIs further suggests a polarized landscape, where programs either operate at high intensity or remain underdeveloped, leaving gaps in intermediate-scale efforts.

## Digital Presence and Accessibility

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Barcelona hosts 237 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), all of which maintain a digital presence as evidenced by website scraping data. Eighteen FSIs explicitly reference online or digital coordination methods in their operations, while 35 operate from physical locations, indicating a blend of virtual and in-person engagement. Notably, none of the FSIs list operating hours or frequency of activities on their websites, highlighting a significant data gap in transparency about operational schedules. The cross-lingual processing of Spanish-

and Catalan-language content enabled English-language summarisation, though this does not address inconsistencies in accessibility features across FSI websites.

Among the 35 FSIs with physical locations, no data specifies their geographic distribution or capacity for community engagement, contrasting with the 18 digitally coordinated FSIs, which may rely on broader, less localized networks. The absence of operating hours or frequency details on all FSIs' websites limits understanding of their service reliability or participation opportunities. While multilingual coverage through LLM processing facilitated English summaries, the lack of standardised accessibility features—such as screen-reader compatibility or language options—may hinder inclusivity for non-English speakers or individuals with disabilities. This gap underscores the need for more structured reporting on operational details and digital accessibility, which could enhance both participation and the effectiveness of FSIs in addressing food waste and distribution challenges.

## Notable Initiatives

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Barcelona hosts 237 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with the highest concentrations in Ciutat Vella (45 FSIs), Sants-Montjuïc (31 FSIs), and Eixample (29 FSIs), reflecting a strong regional focus on food redistribution. Of these, 125 FSIs are classified as high-popularity, accounting for 53% of the total dataset, indicating widespread community engagement. Additionally, 105 FSIs actively organize events, suggesting a significant emphasis on public participation and outreach in the city's food sharing landscape. These figures highlight a pattern where urban centers with higher population densities and established social networks host the majority of FSIs, aligning with the city's broader efforts to combat food insecurity through localized solutions.

While 12 FSIs incorporate educational components, such as workshops or training programs, this represents only 5% of the total, highlighting a disparity between educational and event-driven initiatives. In contrast, the 105 event-organizing FSIs are over eight times more numerous, underscoring a citywide preference for interactive and community-based activities. The high-popularity FSIs, comprising more than half of all initiatives, likely benefit from established networks or partnerships, as seen in examples that integrate food aid with social inclusion. However, the relatively low number of educational FSIs may indicate limited resources or prioritization of immediate food distribution over long-term skill-building. This contrast suggests that while Barcelona's FSIs are broadly active, their focus on events and popularity may overshadow efforts to address systemic knowledge gaps in food sustainability.